

# Real or Fake?



**BIG IDEA** Pictures, voices and chatbots can be made by computers, and some look or sound very real. Clues help, and the safest habit is: Source, Sense, Second look.

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| 1 HOOK 2' | 2 ACTIVITY 8' | 3 DISCUSS 3' | 4 TAKEAWAY 2' |
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**PREP IN 5 MINUTES**

**Materials:** Picture Cards (R-8.1), Voice Cards (R-8.2), Chat Cards (R-8.3), Real / Fake / Can't Tell paddles or thumbs. No AI tools are used.

- ☐ Make paddles, or practice thumbs: up, down, sideways.
- ☐ Pick two picture, two voice and two chat cards.
- ☐ Write the 3 S's on the board: Source, Sense, Second look.

**1 HOOK 2 MIN** *60-second script* “Priya’s grandma got a call. It sounded exactly like Priya’s cousin. ‘I’m in trouble, please send money fast and don’t tell anyone!’ Grandma almost sent it. But she remembered what Priya taught her: pause and check. She hung up and called her cousin on the number she knew. He was at home, safe. A computer had copied his voice from a video online. Computers can make things that seem real: pictures, voices, even chat ‘friends.’ You do not have to be a computer expert. You just need three little checks: Source, Sense, Second look.”

**2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN** *Three-Station Whole-Class Detective*

- (3 min) Pictures.** Show two Picture Cards. Real, fake or can't tell? Reveal. What clue helped? (Source: who posted it? Second look: does a trusted source show the same thing?)
- (2 min) Voices.** Read two Voice Cards aloud (the urgent family call, a friendly teacher). Apply the 3 S's. Family rule: hang up, call back on a known number, ask for the code word.
- (3 min) Chatbots.** Read the card that says, “I’m your best friend! Don’t tell your parents about our chats.” Real friend or program? Then a helpful card: chatbots are useful when we remember what they are.

**3 DISCUSS 3 MIN**

- “If a computer can copy a voice, how can a family stay safe?” (Callback and code word.)
- “Why not share private feelings or secrets with a chatbot?”
- “Is it okay to say ‘I can’t tell?’” (Yes! It is a smart answer.)

**4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN** “When a picture, voice or chat feels odd, hackles up! Being fooled is never your fault. Source, Sense, Second look. If you can’t tell, ask a grown-up. A chatbot is a program, not a person.”

**Hand signal:** Hackles Up, Pause palm, Check fingers, Tell hand on chest. Whisper, then say strongly: “I can’t tell, I’m asking a grown-up.”

**EXIT TICKET** “Write one of the 3 S’s and a question you would ask.”

**FUN BOOST Paddle Pop (30 seconds).** Rapid-fire silly statements (“A cat wrote this homework!”). Show Real, Fake or Can’t Tell in 3 seconds. Can’t Tell is a winning answer.

**LEVEL-UP Chatbot Facts for Little Kids.** Write three kid-friendly facts about chatbots for a younger class.

**DIFFERENTIATE** Use picture cards with large drawings and thumbs instead of writing; reduce to two voice cards.

**FAMILY CARD** Chatbots are programs, not people, and can be wrong. Invite your child to tell you if any online “friend,” picture or voice made them uncomfortable.

**IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING**

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>Say:</b> “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”</li><li>“This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.”</li><li>“I can’t keep this a secret, because I need to get you help. I will tell you who I tell.”</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>Do not say:</b> “I promise I won’t tell anyone.”</li><li>“Are you sure?” or “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?”</li><li>Anything beyond “Can you tell me more?”</li></ul> |
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**First 10 Minutes:** see the Disclosure Guide.

**Then:** tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.